NMRC Website: A Product Case Study

Product Name: NMRC Website

Organization: Noida Metro Rail Corporation (NMRC)

Product Type: Public Transportation Information & Self-Service Portal

Platform: Website

Industry: Public Transportation

Framework: BOI (Build • Observe • Improve)

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1. Why I Chose This Product

I did not choose the NMRC website with the intention of critiquing it. I came across it while trying to solve a real problem in my daily life.

As someone who frequently uses the Noida Metro, I usually rely on Google Maps to check train timings. While it is convenient, I had noticed that the estimated arrival times were occasionally off by two to three minutes. Although the difference was small, it made me wonder whether there was a more reliable source for real-time metro information.

I initially explored other alternatives, such as the "Where Is My Train" application, only to discover that metro systems were not supported. This naturally led me to the official website of the Noida Metro Rail Corporation (NMRC).

What began as a simple search for accurate metro timings gradually turned into an opportunity to observe the product from a user's perspective. As I navigated the website, I started noticing not only how easily I could complete my primary task, but also how different design decisions influenced the overall user experience.

Rather than evaluating the website solely from a visual or technical perspective, I approached it through the lens of product thinking. I wanted to understand why the website was built the way it was, who it was designed to serve, what it did well, where users might experience friction, and how the experience could be improved while balancing user needs with organizational objectives.

This case study is based on my own experience using the website and observations documented through screenshots. It applies product-thinking principles to identify strengths, potential friction points, and opportunities for further investigation.

2. Executive Summary

This case study analyzes the official website of the Noida Metro Rail Corporation (NMRC) using the BOI (Build • Observe • Improve) framework.

The analysis began with a real user need rather than a planned product review. While searching for a more accurate source of metro timings, I explored the NMRC website to understand how effectively it supports users in completing their primary tasks.

The objective of this case study is to understand the product from three perspectives:

- Build: Why the product exists, who it serves, and the business objectives it supports.
- Observe: How users interact with the product, what works well, and where friction occurs during the user journey.
- Improve: Practical recommendations that balance user needs, business goals, and product strategy.

Product: NMRC Website

Primary Goal:
Provide passengers and other stakeholders with official metro information and digital self-service facilities.

Biggest Strength:
The website offers comprehensive information in a single place, supported by a clear route visualization and well-organized information sections.

Key Observed Risk:
The homepage serves multiple user groups, which may create challenges in identifying priority tasks. During my exploration, the linked Card Recharge & Purchase portal was also unreachable, interrupting that user journey.

Top Recommendation:
Prioritize essential commuter tasks such as Journey Planner, Metro Timings, and Card Recharge while reorganizing secondary information to reduce cognitive load and improve task completion.

Overall Takeaway:
The NMRC website succeeds in making important information available to users, but there is an opportunity to improve task prioritization, navigation, and critical user flows. Small product improvements could significantly enhance the overall user experience while supporting NMRC's digital service objectives.

3. BUILD

The BUILD phase focuses on understanding the product before evaluating it. This section explores why the product exists, the problems it aims to solve, who it serves, and the business objectives it supports. Establishing this context creates the foundation for meaningful observations and practical recommendations in the later sections.

3.1 Product Overview

The Noida Metro Rail Corporation (NMRC) website is the official digital platform of the Noida Metro Rail Corporation, which operates the Aqua Line connecting Noida and Greater Noida.

The website acts as a centralized information and self-service portal, providing passengers and other stakeholders with access to essential metro-related services and information. These include journey planning, route maps, fare details, station information, train schedules, smart card services, customer support, official announcements, tenders, recruitment updates, and various public resources.

Unlike commercial products that are often designed around a single primary user journey, the NMRC website serves multiple user groups with diverse objectives. A daily commuter may visit to check train timings or recharge a metro card, while a contractor may access tender information, a job seeker may look for recruitment updates, and a citizen may search for contact information or public notices.

As the official digital touchpoint for NMRC, the website has two primary responsibilities: enabling users to complete essential metro-related tasks efficiently and acting as the organization's official communication platform. Successfully balancing these responsibilities is fundamental to delivering a useful and trustworthy user experience.

3.2 Product Purpose

The NMRC website exists to serve as the official digital gateway between the Noida Metro Rail Corporation and its stakeholders. Its primary purpose is to make metro-related information and services easily accessible, enabling users to complete essential tasks without relying on offline assistance.

For passengers, the website provides a single platform to plan journeys, access route and fare information, check train schedules, recharge metro cards, and stay informed about service updates. By offering these services digitally, the website aims to improve convenience and reduce the dependency on physical ticket counters and customer support.

Beyond commuter services, the website also fulfills the organization's responsibility as a public institution. It acts as an official communication channel by publishing announcements, tenders, recruitment notifications, policies, and other public information. This ensures transparency while making important organizational updates accessible to citizens, businesses, and other stakeholders.

Ultimately, the website is designed to balance two key objectives: delivering efficient digital services for metro users and maintaining a reliable platform for official communication. Achieving both effectively is

essential to providing a seamless user experience while supporting the operational and communication goals of the organization.

3.3 Target Users

The NMRC website is designed to serve multiple user groups, each interacting with the platform for different purposes. Understanding these users is essential because their goals directly influence the product's structure, navigation, and available services.

Daily Commuters

These are regular metro users who depend on the website for routine travel. Their primary objectives include checking train timings, planning journeys, viewing fares, accessing route information, and recharging metro smart cards. For this group, speed, reliability, and ease of access are critical.

First-Time Passengers

Users who are unfamiliar with the Noida Metro require guidance before beginning their journey. They typically look for route maps, station information, fare details, operating hours, and travel instructions. A clear and intuitive information architecture is especially important for these users.

Citizens and General Public

Members of the public may visit the website to access official announcements, customer support, contact information, public notices, lost and found services, or grievance-related resources. Their interactions are less frequent but often task-specific.

Businesses and Contractors

Organizations and vendors use the website to access tender notifications, procurement information, contracts, and other business-related documents. Their priorities are transparency, accessibility, and timely updates.

Job Seekers

Individuals interested in employment opportunities visit the website to view recruitment notifications, eligibility criteria, and application-related information. For these users, discoverability and clarity of information are essential.

Media and Government Stakeholders

Journalists, government departments, and institutional stakeholders may use the website as an official source for press releases, policy updates, and organizational information. For this audience, credibility and timely communication are key expectations.

By serving multiple user groups through a single platform, the NMRC website must balance diverse user needs while ensuring that high-priority commuter tasks remain easy to discover and complete.

3.4 Business Goals

While the internal objectives of the Noida Metro Rail Corporation are not publicly available, the website's design, features, and available services suggest several key business goals.

Provide Digital Self-Service

One of the primary objectives of the website is to enable users to complete common metro-related tasks independently. By providing services such as journey planning, route information, fare details, and smart card management, the website reduces dependence on physical service counters and customer support.

Improve Information Accessibility

The website serves as a centralized source of official information, ensuring that passengers and other stakeholders can easily access accurate and up-to-date details about metro services, operational updates, and organizational announcements.

Enhance Passenger Experience

By making essential travel information available online, the website aims to simplify the travel planning process and improve the overall commuter experience before and during a journey.

Maintain Transparency

As a public sector organization, NMRC has a responsibility to communicate openly with citizens, businesses, and government stakeholders. Publishing tenders, recruitment notifications, policies, and official announcements helps maintain transparency and accountability.

Strengthen Digital Engagement

The website encourages users to interact with NMRC through digital channels rather than relying solely on offline communication. Increasing the adoption of online services can improve operational efficiency while offering greater convenience to users.

Support Organizational Communication

Beyond passenger services, the website functions as the organization's official communication platform. It enables NMRC to share important updates, notices, and information with multiple stakeholder groups through a single, trusted digital channel.

3.5 Success Metrics

The success of the NMRC website can be evaluated by measuring how effectively it helps users complete their tasks while supporting the organization's digital service objectives. Although NMRC's internal product metrics are not publicly available, the following indicators could be used to assess the website's performance.

1. Task Completion Rate

Measures the percentage of users who successfully complete important tasks, such as checking metro timings, finding fare information, locating stations, or accessing service details.

A higher completion rate would indicate that users can accomplish their intended goals more effectively. Task completion should be evaluated through usability testing or reliable interaction data.

2. Time Taken to Find Key Information

Measures how long users take to locate important information, such as first and last metro timings, fare details, station information, or service announcements.

A shorter time to find information may indicate better information architecture and discoverability, provided users can still understand the information accurately.

3. Smart Card Recharge Success Rate

Measures the proportion of users who successfully complete the online smart card recharge process after initiating it.

This metric is particularly relevant because the recharge journey was inaccessible during my recorded attempt. Measuring successful completion would help determine whether users can reliably progress from the NMRC website to the linked service and complete the intended task.

4. Critical Service Availability and Error Rate

Measures the availability of essential digital services, including the Journey Planner and Smart Card Recharge portal, along with the frequency of errors encountered during access.

Monitoring service availability, page-load performance, and technical errors can help identify interruptions in important user journeys. For linked services, monitoring should cover the destination portal as well as the entry point on the NMRC website.

5. Support Requests Related to Common Tasks

Tracks the volume of customer support requests concerning common activities, such as finding metro timings, understanding fares, accessing contact information, or recharging smart cards.

A reduction in recurring queries may suggest that the website is helping users find information and complete tasks independently. However, this metric should be interpreted alongside other evidence, since changes in support requests can have multiple causes.

6. Website Traffic and Returning Visitors

Measures the number of visitors to the website and the proportion who return over a defined period.

These metrics can help indicate whether users continue to access the website for information and services. However, traffic and repeat visits alone do not establish that users are satisfied or completing their tasks successfully.

Supporting Diagnostic Metrics

Metrics such as average session duration, pages visited per session, and interactions with key services can provide additional insight into how users navigate the website.

These should be treated as supporting indicators rather than standalone measures of success. For example, a longer session could indicate greater engagement, but it could also mean that a user is struggling to find information.

Overall Measurement Approach

Together, these metrics provide a balanced view of task effectiveness, information discoverability, service reliability, and the website's role as a digital self-service channel.

The most important measures are task completion rate, time taken to find key information, smart card recharge success rate, and critical service availability. These should be evaluated using usability testing, website analytics, and technical monitoring where available.

No actual performance values are claimed in this case study because internal analytics and service-performance data were not available. The metrics above are proposed measures for evaluating the website, not reported results.

4. OBSERVE

This section examines the NMRC website through the perspective of a real user. It documents the original user scenario, the journey through the website, positive aspects of the experience, and the friction points identified during exploration.

The analysis is based on personal observations and screenshots captured during the initial exploration in May 2026. These findings represent an individual user experience and should not be interpreted as the results of formal usability testing or representative user research.

4.1 User Scenario

The investigation began with a practical need: finding a reliable source for Noida Metro timings.

I usually relied on Google Maps to check metro timings, but I had occasionally noticed a difference of approximately two to three minutes between the displayed estimates and what I expected. This led me to explore alternative sources of information.

I considered the Where Is My Train application, but it did not meet my requirement for checking metro information. I then visited the official Noida Metro Rail Corporation website to explore the information and services available directly from the organization.

My initial objective was to find reliable metro-related information. As I explored the website, my attention expanded beyond this original task to include its navigation, information structure, route visualization, contact details, and online smart card recharge facility.

This broader exploration helped me identify both strengths and potential usability issues. In particular, I noticed the value of the animated route visualization and organized information sections, alongside potential friction created by the volume of content, email address formatting, and the recharge link that did not load successfully during my attempt.

The scenario illustrates how an ordinary user need can lead to broader product observations. However, the findings reflect my own experience and do not establish how frequently other users encounter the same issues.

4.2 User Journey

The user journey began with the need to find reliable metro timings and developed into a broader exploration of the NMRC website.

Stage 1: Identify the Need

The user wants to check Noida Metro timings and is looking for a dependable source of information.

Stage 2: Explore Existing Alternatives

Google Maps is the initial source, but occasional differences in displayed timings create a reason to look for alternatives. Another application is considered but does not meet the user's requirements.

Stage 3: Discover the Official Website

The user visits the NMRC website to explore official metro information and available passenger services.

Stage 4: Explore the Homepage

The user encounters several information sections, including metro-related information, announcements, useful links, and other organizational resources. This provides multiple avenues for exploration but also introduces a substantial amount of information on a single page.

Stage 5: Evaluate the Website Experience

While exploring the website, the user notices positive elements such as the animated metro, structured information blocks, and route visualization. The user also notices that email addresses are displayed using formats such as "[at]" and "[dot]," which may require additional effort when contacting the organization.

Stage 6: Attempt an Important Digital Task

The user attempts to access the Card Recharge and Purchase service. The linked portal does not load successfully during the attempt, interrupting access to a potentially important commuter task.

Stage 7: Form an Overall Assessment

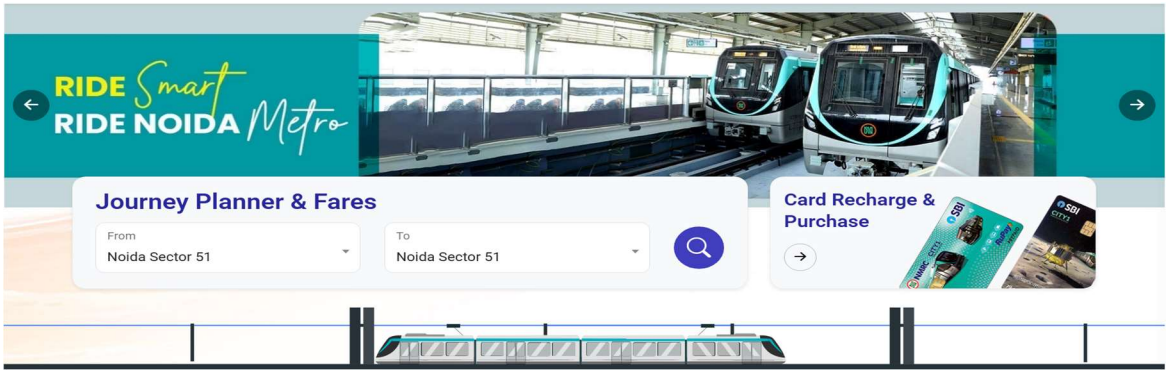
The experience reveals a combination of useful information, engaging interface elements, and potential usability issues. The user concludes that the website has value as an information platform but could improve the prioritization of important tasks and the reliability of critical user journeys.

The journey above reconstructs the experience from the original observations. It does not imply that every step was formally timed or that the same journey would occur for every visitor.

4.3 Screenshots

The following screenshots were captured during my exploration of the NMRC website in May 2026. They document the interface, information structure, and services that informed my observations in this case study. Each screenshot is used as visual evidence for specific aspects of the product experience.

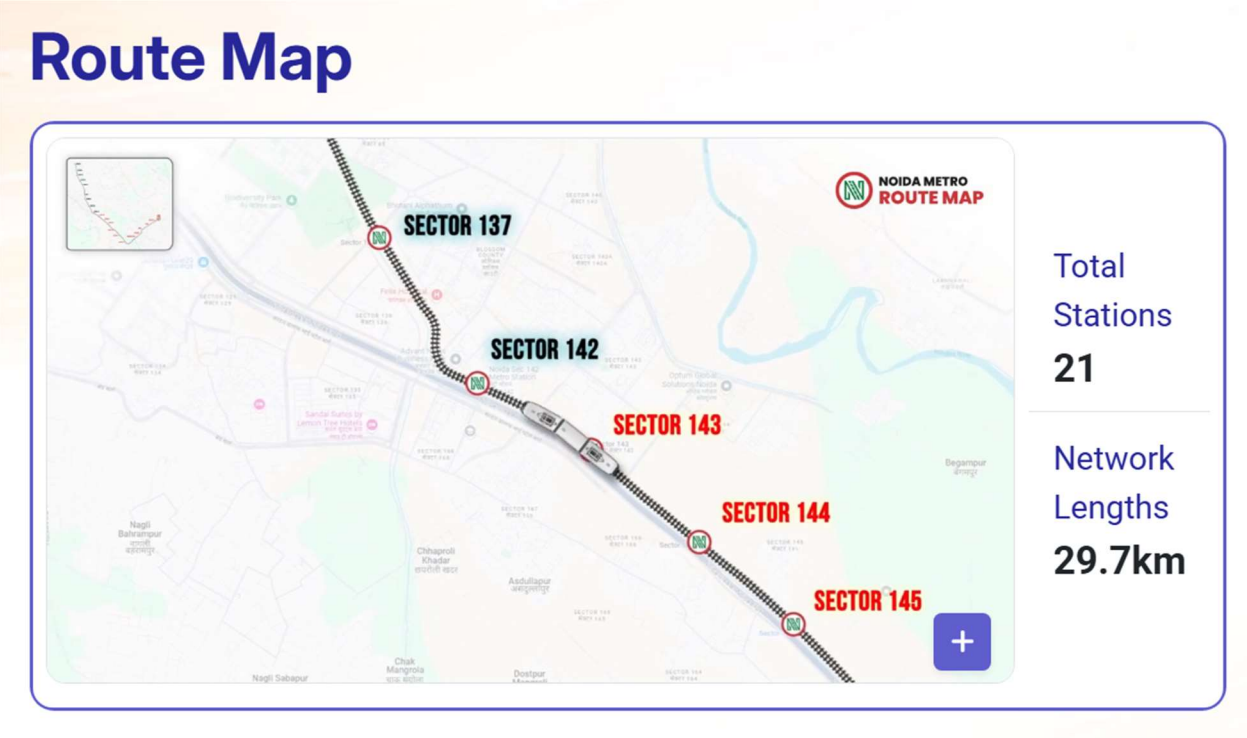
Figure 1: Homepage and Journey Planner



This screenshot shows the main homepage banner, Journey Planner & Fares section, and Card Recharge & Purchase entry point. The Journey Planner provides fields for selecting the origin and destination, while the recharge section offers a separate entry point to a digital service.

The screenshot shows that the Journey Planner and Card Recharge & Purchase entry points are visible near the top of the homepage. However, the broader page contains information for several audiences, making it worth evaluating whether the overall hierarchy consistently helps users identify their next action.

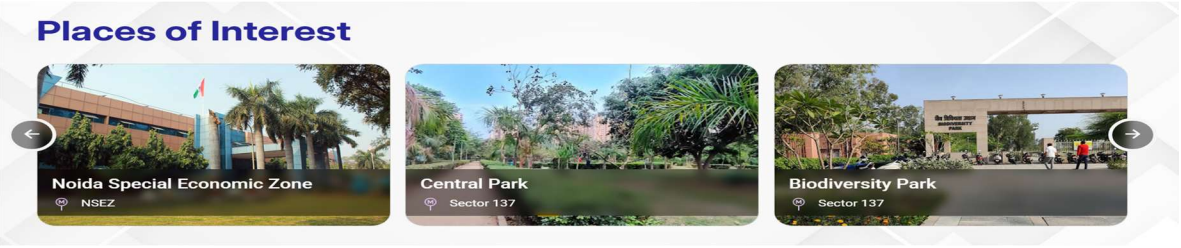
Figure 2: Metro Route Map



This screenshot shows the NMRC route map, including station labels, the network visualization, and displayed network information such as the total number of stations and network length.

The visual representation provides an alternative to navigating metro information through text alone. It can help users understand the route and identify stations, particularly when planning an unfamiliar journey.

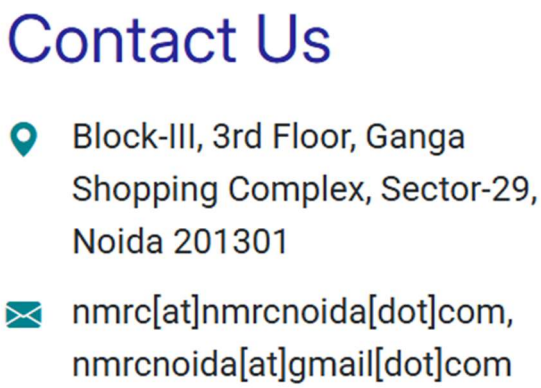
Figure 3: Places of Interest



This screenshot displays places of interest, including Noida Special Economic Zone, Central Park, and Biodiversity Park, with associated location information.

The section extends the website's usefulness beyond basic metro operations by connecting the transport network with nearby destinations. It offers additional value to users who want to explore places accessible through the metro network.

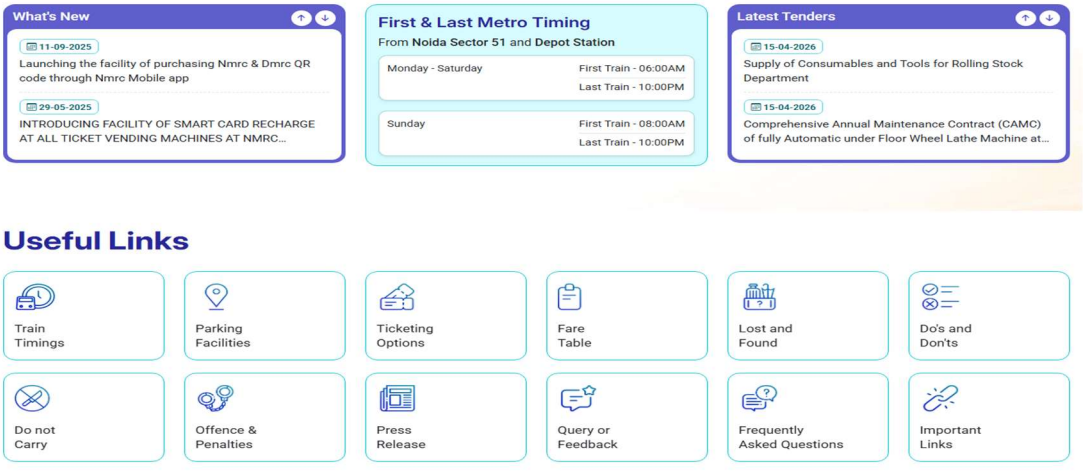
Figure 4: Contact Information



This screenshot displays NMRC's contact address and email addresses formatted using "[at]" and "[dot]" instead of conventional email symbols.

While this formatting may be intended to reduce automated email harvesting, it can create additional effort for users who want to copy or use the contact details. This screenshot supports the observation about the trade-off between spam prevention and contact accessibility.

Figure 5: Metro Timings, Announcements, Tenders, and Useful Links



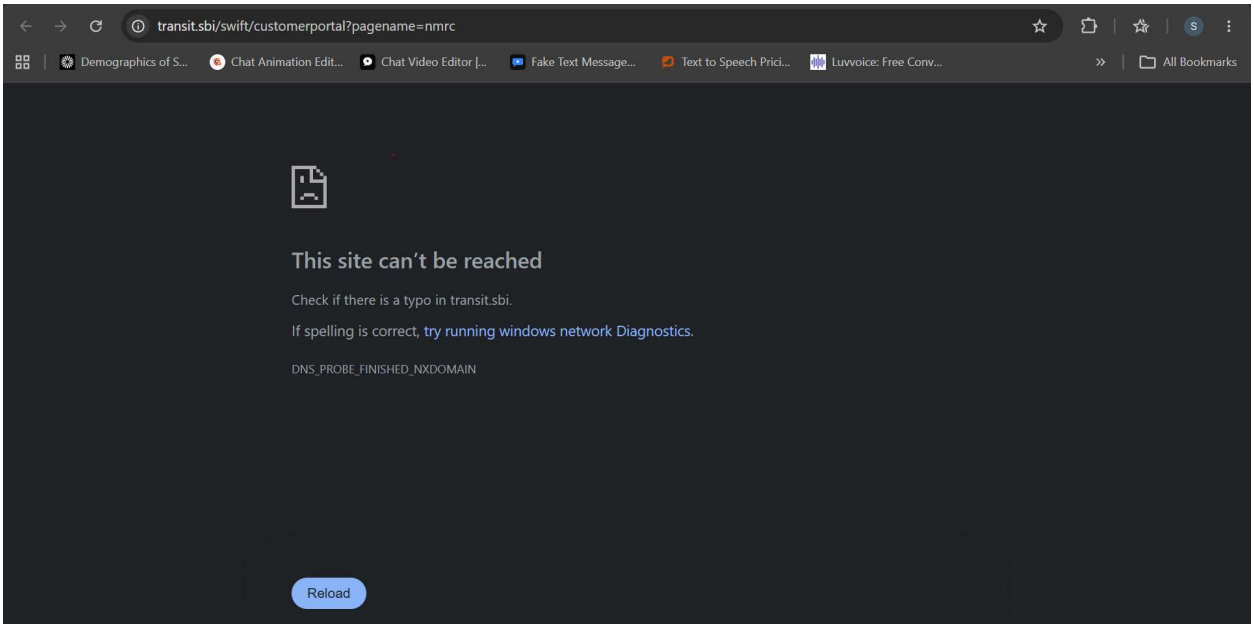
This screenshot shows several information blocks on the homepage, including What's New, First & Last Metro Timing, Latest Tenders, and a collection of Useful Links.

The displayed information covers several distinct needs, ranging from checking operating hours and reading service announcements to accessing fare tables, ticketing information, lost and found resources, and other public information.

The screenshot illustrates the breadth of information available on the homepage. Although this centralized structure makes many resources accessible from one location, it also raises a product-design question: how easily can users identify the information most relevant to their immediate task?

These screenshots support the observations discussed throughout the case study. They document the interface as captured in May 2026 and provide a visual basis for evaluating its information structure, service discoverability, and user experience. They do not independently establish the frequency of usability issues, their impact on other users, or the current status of linked services.

Figure 6: Card Recharge & Purchase — Redirect Error



After selecting the "Card Recharge & Purchase" option on the NMRC homepage, I was redirected to an SBI-hosted customer portal URL. The browser displayed "This site can't be reached" with the error code DNS_PROBE_FINISHED_NXDOMAIN.

This screenshot documents the error encountered during my attempt to access the recharge portal. It does not establish the root cause, how long the issue lasted, or whether other users experienced the same problem.

4.4 What Works Well

The NMRC website demonstrates several strengths in how it presents transport information and organizational resources. These observations focus on the value provided by the interface rather than assuming that every design decision produces the same outcome for all users.

1. Animated Metro Element

The animated metro element adds movement to the website and establishes a clear connection with the service being represented. It makes the interface feel more engaging than a page consisting entirely of static text and information blocks.

From a product perspective, visual elements can reinforce the identity of a service when they support rather than distract from the user's primary task.

2. Structured Information Blocks

Sections such as First/Last Metro, What's New, Tenders, and Useful Links organize information into recognizable categories. This allows users to scan the page and identify areas that may be relevant to their needs.

The structure also accommodates the website's different audiences, including passengers and people looking for organizational information.

However, the usefulness of this structure depends on how easily users can identify the right section. The presence of categorized information does not automatically guarantee that every task is easy to complete.

3. Animated Route Visualization

The route visualization presents the metro network in a visual format that can help users understand the route and its stations.

This is particularly useful for people unfamiliar with the network, as a visual representation can make spatial relationships easier to understand than a list of station names alone.

4. Access to Multiple Types of Information

The website brings together passenger information and organizational resources in one official location. Users can explore metro timings, route information, announcements, tenders, and contact details without needing to begin their search across multiple unrelated websites.

This centralization can support the organization's role as an official information source, provided the information remains accurate and the linked services remain accessible.

5. Places of Interest

The inclusion of nearby places of interest, such as Biodiversity Park, extends the website's usefulness beyond basic transit information.

This introduces an exploratory dimension to the experience by connecting the metro network with destinations that users may want to visit. It is an example of how a transport information platform can provide additional value beyond answering immediate travel questions.

Overall, the website's strengths lie in its breadth of information, recognizable content categories, visual representation of the route, and inclusion of resources that support both travel and broader public information needs.

4.5 Pain Points

The exploration revealed three potential areas of friction. Each is described in terms of the observed behaviour, its possible effect on users, and the implications for the product. The underlying causes and the prevalence of these issues have not been independently established.

1. High Information Density on the Homepage

Observation:

The homepage presents a large amount of information across several sections. Although the content is organized into categories, users encounter multiple types of information within the same overall experience.

Evidence:

The homepage screenshots show several information blocks and links presented together.

Why It Matters:

Different users arrive with different goals. A commuter may want to check metro timings or recharge a card, while another visitor may be looking for tenders, recruitment information, or official announcements.

Presenting these needs on the same page supports broad access to information, but it may make the most relevant action less obvious to users who arrive with a specific task.

Potential User Impact:

First-time visitors may need to spend additional time scanning the page before identifying the relevant section. Users who already know what they want may find the amount of competing information unnecessary.

Potential Business Impact:

If users struggle to locate important services, the website may be less effective as a self-service channel. This is a potential risk rather than a measured outcome, as no analytics or task-completion data were available.

2. Email Address Formatting

Observation:

Some email addresses are displayed using "[at]" instead of "@" and "[dot]" instead of ".".

Evidence:

The contact information visible in the screenshots and described in the original LinkedIn post.

Why It Matters:

This formatting is sometimes used to reduce automated email harvesting and spam. However, it can introduce an extra step for people who want to contact the organization.

Potential User Impact:

Users may need to manually replace the text before using an email address. This can create friction, particularly on mobile devices, where copying, editing, and switching between applications may be inconvenient.

Potential Business Impact:

Additional effort in contacting the organization could discourage some users from completing their intended communication. The scale of this effect is unknown.

3. Card Recharge and Purchase Link Failure

Observation:

During my exploration, selecting the "Card Recharge & Purchase" link on the NMRC homepage redirected me to an SBI-hosted customer portal. The destination page did not load successfully and displayed a browser error.

Evidence:

A screenshot captured during the attempt shows the redirected URL:

transit.sbi/swift/customerportal?pagename=nmrc

The browser displayed the message "This site can't be reached" along with the error code DNS_PROBE_FINISHED_NXDOMAIN.

Why It Matters:

Smart card recharge is a potentially important task for regular commuters. When a link to a digital service leads to an inaccessible destination, users may be unable to continue their intended journey through that route.

Potential User Impact:

A user attempting to recharge or purchase a card may need to retry, find an alternative channel, or complete the task elsewhere. This introduces uncertainty and interrupts the intended experience.

Potential Business Impact:

An inaccessible digital service can undermine confidence in the website's reliability and reduce the effectiveness of its self-service offering.

Important Limitation:

The screenshot confirms that the destination portal could not be reached during my attempt. The error code indicates a DNS resolution problem at that time, but it does not establish the underlying cause or whether the issue affected other users. The failure could relate to the destination domain, DNS configuration, or another temporary or technical condition. The current status of the service has not been established by this observation.

Follow-up Check:

During a subsequent attempt on 23 October 2026, I checked the Card Recharge & Purchase portal again and found that it was still inaccessible. This provides a second observation of the access problem on a separate date. However, it does not establish that the service was continuously unavailable between attempts or identify the underlying cause. Further technical investigation would be needed to determine where the failure occurs.

Summary of Pain Points

The three observations point to different types of friction: information discovery, communication accessibility, and access to a critical digital service. They should not be treated as equally severe. The recharge failure has the clearest potential to prevent task completion, while the other two primarily concern the effort required to find information or contact the organization.

These findings are based on personal exploration and screenshots rather than formal usability testing or website analytics. They identify areas worth investigating further, not proof of widespread user problems.

4.6 Interesting Product Decisions

Beyond the positive observations and pain points, the NMRC website illustrates several product decisions worth examining. These are interpretations of the visible experience, not claims about the organization's internal reasoning.

1. **Serving Multiple Audiences Through One Website**

The website brings passenger services, public information, tenders, recruitment-related information, and other organizational resources together in a single platform.

This approach provides a centralized destination for different stakeholder groups and avoids requiring a separate website for every audience.

The trade-off is that users with very different goals must navigate the same broad information environment. The product challenge is to maintain comprehensive coverage without making the most common passenger tasks difficult to discover.

2. **Balancing Visual Engagement With Task Efficiency**

The animated metro and route visualization contribute to the website's visual identity and help communicate the nature of the service.

At the same time, public transport websites need to support quick access to practical information. Visual engagement is valuable when it improves understanding or creates a clearer sense of place, but it should not compete with important tasks or negatively affect performance and accessibility.

The key product question is whether visual elements support the user's goal while maintaining a fast, usable experience.

3. **Centralized Information Versus Task Prioritization**

Making many categories of information available on the homepage can improve visibility and provide broad access to organizational resources.

However, the same approach may create competition between high-frequency commuter tasks and less frequent informational needs.

A potential improvement opportunity is to distinguish essential passenger actions from secondary resources more clearly. This would preserve the breadth of information while making common tasks easier to identify.

4. **Spam Prevention Versus Contact Accessibility**

Displaying email addresses with "[at]" and "[dot]" may reflect an attempt to reduce spam exposure. However, it also introduces manual effort for users who want to contact the organization.

This illustrates a familiar product trade-off: a decision intended to protect one aspect of the service may make another aspect less convenient.

Any alternative should consider spam prevention, accessibility, mobile usability, and the practical needs of people contacting the organization.

5. **Dependence on Linked Digital Services**

The unsuccessful Card Recharge and Purchase attempt highlights a broader product consideration: a user journey can depend on services beyond the page where it begins.

Even when the main website loads correctly, a linked portal that is unavailable can prevent the user from completing the intended task.

This makes the reliability of external or connected services an important part of the overall experience. From the user's perspective, the journey is only as successful as its critical steps, regardless of which technical system is responsible for a failure.

Overall, the NMRC website presents a useful example of the balance between comprehensive information, visual presentation, accessibility, and task completion. Its strengths and observed friction points suggest opportunities to evaluate the experience through complete user journeys rather than individual screens alone.

5. IMPROVE

The IMPROVE phase translates the observations from the previous section into practical opportunities to enhance the NMRC website. The objective is not to redesign the entire platform, but to identify targeted changes that could make important tasks easier to complete, reduce unnecessary friction, and improve the reliability of digital services.

The recommendations are based on the individual user experience documented in this case study. Their expected impact has not been validated through user testing or internal performance data. They should therefore be treated as hypotheses that NMRC could evaluate through further investigation.

5.1 Improvement Recommendations

Recommendation 1: Prioritize Essential Commuter Tasks

Problem Identified:

The homepage presents information for multiple audiences, including commuters, businesses, job seekers, and the general public. Although this makes a wide range of resources available, users may need to scan several sections to identify the information relevant to their immediate needs.

Evidence:

Figures 1 and 5 show the Journey Planner, metro timings, announcements, tenders, and multiple Useful Links categories.

Recommendation:

Organize the homepage around clearly prioritized user tasks. Essential commuter actions, such as Journey Planner, Metro Timings, Fare Information, and Card Recharge, should remain easy to identify. Secondary resources, including tenders, recruitment information, and organizational announcements, can remain accessible through clearly labeled sections.

The aim is not to remove useful information but to establish a clearer visual hierarchy between frequent passenger tasks and other resources.

Expected User Impact:

Commuters and first-time passengers may be able to identify relevant actions more quickly, with less effort spent scanning the homepage.

Expected Business Impact:

A clearer hierarchy could improve the website's effectiveness as a self-service platform and encourage users to complete their intended tasks digitally.

Trade-offs:

Reorganizing the homepage requires design and development effort. Changes must also preserve the visibility and accessibility of information required by other stakeholder groups.

How to Evaluate:

Measure task completion rate and time taken to locate key services. Usability testing could compare the existing layout with the proposed hierarchy to determine whether users can find essential tasks more efficiently.

Recommendation 2: Improve Contact Information Accessibility

Problem Identified:

The email addresses shown on the website use "[at]" and "[dot]" instead of conventional email symbols. This may introduce additional steps for users who want to contact NMRC.

Evidence:

Figure 4 shows the contact information and the alternative formatting of the email addresses.

Recommendation:

Evaluate a more accessible approach to protecting contact information from automated spam. Options could include a properly labeled contact form, a clickable email link where appropriate, or other accessible contact mechanisms that balance spam prevention with ease of use.

The final approach should be selected after considering accessibility, privacy, spam prevention, and the organization's ability to manage incoming requests.

Expected User Impact:

Users may find it easier to contact the organization without manually editing email addresses or switching between applications.

Expected Business Impact:

A simpler contact experience could reduce communication friction and help users reach the appropriate channel for their enquiries.

Trade-offs:

Clickable email addresses may attract automated spam. Contact forms require maintenance and may introduce their own usability or privacy concerns. The solution should balance accessibility with operational requirements.

How to Evaluate:

Test whether users can identify and use the intended contact method successfully. A suitable metric could be the percentage of users who successfully initiate contact through the available channel.

Recommendation 3: Investigate and Improve the Card Recharge Journey

Problem Identified:

During my original exploration in May 2026, the Card Recharge & Purchase link led to a portal that did not load successfully. During a subsequent retest on 23 October 2026, the portal was still inaccessible. These repeated observations suggest that the access issue warrants further investigation, although the underlying cause and the duration of the problem have not been established.

Evidence:

Figure 1 shows the Card Recharge & Purchase entry point on the NMRC homepage. Figure 6 documents the unsuccessful attempt in May 2026, including the browser error code. A subsequent retest on 23 October 2026 also found the portal inaccessible.

Recommendation:

First, investigate the complete recharge journey to establish where the failure occurs. Check whether the entry link works, whether the destination portal is available, and whether the issue can be reproduced across different browsers and devices.

If the failure is confirmed, prioritize resolving the underlying issue. Where appropriate, provide a clear error message, a retry option, and guidance to an alternative official recharge channel. Any alternative should be verified before being presented to users.

Expected User Impact:

A more reliable journey could help commuters access recharge services with less uncertainty and fewer interruptions.

Expected Business Impact:

Improving the reliability of a critical digital service could support self-service adoption and maintain confidence in NMRC's online services.

Trade-offs:

The issue may originate in a connected portal or an external dependency rather than the main website. Resolving it may therefore require coordination across technical teams or service providers. Error handling and alternative channels must also remain accurate and up to date.

How to Evaluate:

Monitor recharge-link availability, destination portal errors, successful recharge completion rate, and the number of users who abandon the process. These measures would help identify whether the journey is becoming more reliable.

5.2 Prioritization

The recommendations should be prioritized according to their potential impact on users, the importance of the affected task, the urgency of the issue, and the effort required to implement a solution.

The following is an initial qualitative prioritization based on the available observations. It is not a validated assessment of NMRC's internal costs, technical constraints, or business priorities.

Priority 1: Investigate the Card Recharge Journey

Rationale:

The recharge portal was inaccessible during my original exploration in May 2026 and remained inaccessible during a subsequent retest. Because this may prevent users from accessing an important commuter service, the first step should be to reproduce the issue, determine where the failure occurs, and establish whether the problem lies with the NMRC entry link, the destination portal, or another technical dependency.

The repeated observations increase the importance of investigating the issue, but its root cause, duration, and impact on other users remain unverified.

Expected Effort: Unknown until the cause is identified.

Priority 2: Improve the Homepage's Task Hierarchy

Rationale:

The homepage serves multiple audiences, and the screenshots show several categories of information competing for attention. A clearer hierarchy could benefit users who arrive with immediate travel-related needs.

Expected Effort: Medium to High, depending on the extent of redesign and implementation required.

Priority 3: Improve Contact Information Accessibility

Rationale:

The email formatting creates a relatively small but avoidable source of friction. Alternative contact mechanisms could be explored without necessarily requiring a complete homepage redesign.

Expected Effort: Low to Medium, depending on the selected solution and existing technical infrastructure.

Prioritization Summary

The recharge journey should be investigated first because it may block completion of an important task. Homepage hierarchy comes next because it affects how easily users discover services. Contact accessibility remains a worthwhile improvement, although its urgency is comparatively lower based on the evidence currently available.

These priorities may change after reproducing the recharge issue, testing the homepage with representative users, and understanding the implementation constraints. The purpose of prioritization is to guide investigation and decision-making, not to imply certainty where evidence is limited.

6. Product Takeaways

The NMRC website investigation demonstrates how Product Management thinking can be applied to an existing digital product. By examining the product's purpose, observing the user journey, and identifying opportunities for improvement, I developed several lessons that can be applied to other products.

1. Start With the User's Problem

My investigation began with a practical need: finding a reliable source for Noida Metro timings. This gave the analysis a clear starting point and helped me evaluate the website in the context of an actual user objective.

Product takeaway: Before suggesting features or redesigning an interface, understand what the user is trying to accomplish and why the existing experience may not fully meet that need.

2. Information Availability Is Not the Same as Accessibility

The NMRC website brings together passenger information, route maps, announcements, tenders, contact details, and other public resources. However, making information available does not automatically mean users can find and use it easily.

The homepage illustrates the challenge of serving different audiences while keeping essential commuter tasks discoverable.

Product takeaway: Evaluate information architecture and task discoverability alongside the quantity and breadth of information a product provides.

3. Evaluate the Complete User Journey

The Card Recharge & Purchase experience highlighted an important distinction between making a service accessible from a homepage and enabling users to complete the intended task.

In my attempt, selecting the recharge option led to a portal that could not be reached. Although the root cause was not established, the experience demonstrated how a failure at one step can interrupt the overall journey.

Product takeaway: Assess the complete user journey, including redirects and connected services, rather than evaluating individual screens in isolation.

4. Product Decisions Involve Trade-offs

The NMRC website illustrates several potential trade-offs. Serving multiple audiences through one website supports centralized access to information, while displaying many categories together may make prioritization more challenging. Similarly, alternative email formatting may help reduce automated spam but introduce additional effort for people trying to make contact.

These observations do not establish the organization's original intentions or prove that the design choices are ineffective. They highlight questions worth evaluating from the user's perspective.

Product takeaway: Understand the purpose and trade-offs behind a design decision before recommending a change. The goal is to find a better balance between user needs and organizational requirements.

5. Separate Evidence From Assumptions

The screenshots provided direct evidence of the website's visible interface and the error encountered during my recharge attempt. However, they did not establish how frequently other users experience these issues, quantify their impact, or reveal the underlying technical cause.

The homepage information density and email formatting also represent potential sources of friction rather than proven usability failures.

Product takeaway: Clearly distinguish observed behaviour from interpretation and hypothesis. Use usability testing, analytics, technical investigation, and user feedback to validate findings before making major product decisions.

6. Prioritize Investigation Before Implementation

The recharge journey was prioritized because the observed error could prevent access to an important commuter service. However, the appropriate solution cannot be selected until the issue is reproduced and its cause is better understood.

Homepage organization and contact accessibility present additional opportunities that could be investigated and evaluated.

Product takeaway: Prioritization is not simply about choosing which feature to build first. It also involves identifying what needs to be investigated, assessing potential user impact, and gathering enough evidence to make informed decisions.

Overall Learning

The BOI (Build • Observe • Improve) framework provides a structured way to approach product analysis.

- **Build:** Understand the product, its users, its purpose, and its likely organizational objectives.
- **Observe:** Examine the actual experience, document evidence, and identify potential friction.
- **Improve:** Translate observations into actionable recommendations, prioritize further investigation, and define ways to evaluate outcomes.

The central lesson is that effective product thinking begins with understanding the problem and examining the evidence. Recommendations become more valuable when they are grounded in user needs, realistic constraints, and clearly defined ways to measure success.

7. Final Reflection

This case study began with a simple attempt to find a reliable source for Noida Metro timings. What started as an everyday information search became an opportunity to examine an existing digital product through a Product Management perspective.

During the investigation, I learned to look beyond the visual interface and consider the wider experience: why the website exists, who it serves, how its information is organized, and what happens when a user attempts to complete an important task.

One of the most useful parts of this exercise was documenting the Card Recharge & Purchase error. Rather than assuming that the entire NMRC website was unreliable, I focused on the specific behaviour I observed, recorded the browser error, and considered possible implications without claiming to know the underlying cause. This reinforced the importance of being precise about what the evidence does and does not establish.

The investigation also had limitations. It was based on my personal experience and six screenshots, not formal usability testing, representative user research, or access to internal analytics and technical logs. Consequently, the identified pain points and recommendations should be treated as initial findings and hypotheses rather than validated conclusions about the experience of all NMRC users.

If I were to continue this investigation, I would first try to reproduce the recharge issue and determine where the failure occurs. I would then test how representative users find essential information on the homepage and examine whether alternative contact methods could make communication easier. Where appropriate, I would use task completion rates, time taken to locate information, and service availability data to evaluate the findings.

Completing this case study has given me practical experience in moving from a real user problem to structured observations and prioritized improvement opportunities. It has also helped me recognize where further evidence is needed before recommending implementation.

I intend to build on this experience by analyzing more digital products, applying the BOI framework, and improving my ability to connect user experience observations with product goals and measurable outcomes.

Ultimately, this case study is not an attempt to declare the NMRC website a failed product. It is an exercise in understanding an existing product, recognizing its strengths, identifying opportunities for improvement, and developing a more evidence-based approach to Product Management.